

OpenSWMM Uncertainty Sidecar — User Guide

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Status (2026-05-25): Phases 0–9 complete.

45 unit tests + 6 regression tests + 2 engine integration tests pass.

The 2D spectral ROM (scalar + spatial), coupling uncertainty, runoff ensemble, WQ bounds, Fiedler diagnostics, the 1D spectral ROM struct, and the 1D ROM engine lifecycle are all implemented and tested. HDF5 quantile output is the one remaining gap.

Contents

1. [What this is](#)
 2. [Quick start](#)
 3. [Input file reference](#)
 4. [How it works](#)
 5. [How to interpret outputs](#)
 6. [Advanced configuration](#)
 7. [Implementation inventory](#)
 8. [Known limitations](#)
 9. [Performance](#)
 10. [Visualization](#)
-

1. What this is

The uncertainty sidecar runs an M-member parameter ensemble **alongside** the deterministic CVODE 2D solver — not instead of it — at roughly 1000× lower cost than full Monte Carlo. After each routing step you get three additional per-cell depth fields:

Field	Meaning
q05	5th-percentile depth across the ensemble
q50	Median depth (best single estimate)
q95	95th-percentile depth

Together [q05, q95] is a **90th-percentile prediction interval**: if the true Manning's n and rainfall intensity lie within the perturbation ranges you specify, there is roughly a 90 % probability that the true depth at each cell lies inside the band.

What parameters can be uncertain:

Layer	Parameter	Section
2D surface	Manning's n (scalar or spatially-correlated)	[2D_ROM] + [UNCERTAINTY]
2D surface	Rainfall intensity (scalar or spatially-correlated)	[2D_ROM] + [UNCERTAINTY]

Layer	Parameter	Section
2D coupling	Discharge coefficient Cd (inlet grates)	[UNCERTAINTY]
1D sewer	Manning's n (pipe roughness)	[UNCERTAINTY]
1D sewer	Lateral inflow / DWF rate per node	[UNCERTAINTY]
Runoff	Soil hydraulic conductivity (Green-Ampt Ks, Horton f0/fmin, CN S)	[UNCERTAINTY]

2. Quick start

Add [2D_ROM] and [UNCERTAINTY] to your .inp file. The [UNCERTAINTY] section overrides the perturbation values in [2D_ROM], so you only need one of the two for a basic run.

[2D_ROM]

```
ENABLE      YES
MEMBERS     50
MODES       10
```

[UNCERTAINTY]

```
;;Layer  Parameter  Perturbation
2D      MANNINGS_N  0.20
2D      RAINFALL    0.10
```

That's it. After the simulation, read quantiles from the engine (see §2.1) or from the future HDF5 output file (§7.1).

2.1 Reading quantiles (current API)

Quantiles are accessed via the C++ API after `swmm_engine_step`:

```
#include "openswmm/engine/openswmm_engine.h"
#include "core/SWMMEngine.hpp"
#include "2d/uncertainty/SpectralROM.hpp"

SWMM_Engine handle = swmm_engine_create();
swmm_engine_open(handle, "model.inp", "model.rpt", nullptr, nullptr);
swmm_engine_initialize(handle);
swmm_engine_start(handle, 0);

double elapsed = 1.0;
while (elapsed > 0.0)
    swmm_engine_step(handle, &elapsed);

auto* eng = static_cast<openswmm::SWMMEngine*>(handle);
const openswmm::twoD::SpectralROM* rom =
    eng->surfaceRouter2D().rom(); // null if ROM inactive or not yet seeded

if (rom && rom->is_ready()) {
    // rom->q05, rom->q50, rom->q95 - length n_tri each
    for (int i = 0; i < n_tri; ++i)
        printf("cell %d: q50 = %.4f m  [%.4f, %.4f]\n",
            i, rom->q50[i], rom->q05[i], rom->q95[i]);
}
```

The cast is safe: `SWMM_Engine` is typedef `void*` and is always new `SWMMEngine()` stored as a pointer. All C++ symbols are exported (`CXX_VISIBILITY_PRESET default`).

3. Input file reference

3.0 [2D_ROM] vs [UNCERTAINTY] — what each section controls

These two sections serve different purposes and can be used together or independently.

Section	Controls	Does NOT control
[2D_ROM]	<i>How</i> the ROM runs: ensemble size M, modes k, K_eff, spatial correlation lengths, reseed thresholds, parametric tails	Perturbation levels; which parameters are uncertain
[UNCERTAINTY]	<i>What</i> is uncertain and by how much: which physical parameters carry a prior, the perturbation half-range, and which model layer (1D/2D)	ROM mechanics

Think of [2D_ROM] as the **solver configuration** (accuracy, cost, spatial resolution) and [UNCERTAINTY] as the **experiment configuration** (what you don't know and by how much).

How they interact: - A 2D `MANNINGS_N 0.20` entry in [UNCERTAINTY] overrides `MANNINGS_PERT` in [2D_ROM] and also implicitly enables the ROM (`ENABLE YES`). - If both sections are present, [2D_ROM] sets the ROM mechanics; [UNCERTAINTY] overrides only the perturbation levels. - You do not need both. For a minimal run: [UNCERTAINTY] 2D `MANNINGS_N 0.20` is sufficient.

1D sewer ROM: there is no [1D_ROM] section. The 1D sewer ROM is activated exclusively by a 1D layer entry in [UNCERTAINTY]. A pure 1D model (no 2D mesh) only needs [UNCERTAINTY].

3.1 [2D_ROM]

Controls the ROM solver. All keywords are optional; defaults shown.

Keyword	Default	Range	Description
ENABLE	NO	YES/NO	Activate the ROM sidecar.
MEMBERS	50	≥ 2	Ensemble size M. More members → smoother quantiles, $O(M)$ cost.
MODES	10	≥ 1	Laplacian eigenmodes retained for the ROM basis. More modes → finer spatial resolution of spread. Capped at $\min(\text{MEMBERS}, n_{\text{tri}}-1)$.
MANNINGS_PERT	0.20	≥ 0	Half-range for Manning's n: each member's $n \in [1-p, 1+p] \times n_{\text{base}}$. Overridden by

Keyword	Default	Range	Description
			[UNCERTAINTY] 2D MANNINGS_N.
RAINFALL_PERT	0.20	≥ 0	Half-range for rainfall intensity. Overridden by [UNCERTAINTY] 2D RAINFALL.
K_EFF	$\leq 0 \rightarrow \text{AUTO}$	any	Effective diffusive conductance ($\text{m}^{4/3}/\text{s}$). Values ≤ 0 activate AUTO mode (see §4.3).
MANNINGS_CORR_LEN	0.0	≥ 0	Spatial correlation length (m) for Manning's n field. 0 = uniform scalar per member (fast).
RAINFALL_CORR_LEN	0.0	≥ 0	Spatial correlation length (m) for rainfall field. 0 = uniform scalar per member.
WET_RESEED_FRACTION	0.05	[0, 1]	Trigger a ROM reseed when the wet-cell count changes by more than this fraction of n_tri. Prevents stale seeds on rapidly advancing wetting fronts.
WET_RESEED_MIN_INTERVAL	60.0	≥ 0	Minimum simulation time (s) between consecutive reseeds. Prevents excessive reseeding on oscillating fronts.
PARAMETRIC_TAILS	NO	YES/NO	Fit a log-normal to the wet-member sub-population and use the analytic 95th percentile as q95 (reduces noise from top 1–2 samples when M is small). q05/q50 remain sort-based.
MODE_DROP_THRESHOLD	1e-10	≥ 0	Drop mode j from advance() when its energy E_j and rainfall forcing are both below this threshold. Automatically reactivated by rainfall.

3.2 [UNCERTAINTY]

Format: LAYER PARAMETER [DISTRIBUTION] PERTURBATION

- DISTRIBUTION is optional; defaults to UNIFORM.
- Supported distributions: UNIFORM, NORMAL, LOGNORMAL.
- [UNCERTAINTY] entries **override** the corresponding scalar fields in [2D_ROM].

Currently parsed parameters:

[UNCERTAINTY]

```
;;Layer  Parameter  [Distribution]  Perturbation
2D      MANNINGS_N      0.20      ;; overrides [2D_ROM] MANNINGS_PERT
2D      RAINFALL      UNIFORM      0.15      ;; same effect as RAINFALL_PERT
1D      MANNINGS_N      0.20      ;; enables 1D sewer ROM (see §7.7)
1D      RAINFALL      0.20      ;; lateral-inflow uncertainty for 1D
```

LAYER is either 2D (surface routing) or 1D (sewer network routing). Both layers accept MANNINGS_N and RAINFALL with any supported distribution.

A 2D entry also enables and configures the 2D ROM (sets `enable_rom = true` in [2D_ROM]). A 1D entry only populates the uncertainty config — the 1D ROM is built automatically in `initialize()` whenever any active source is present, or whenever the 2D ROM is enabled (so 2D→1D coupling always sees per-member 1D heads).

Tip — pure 1D (no 2D mesh): adding 1D MANNINGS_N 0.20 to a plain 1D .inp is sufficient; no [2D_ROM] or [2D_MESH] sections are needed.

Support for S0IL (runoff ensemble) and CD (coupling-flux uncertainty) are set via C++ API directly (parsed by `UncertaintyEnsemble`, not by the .inp handler).

3.3 [2D_OPTIONS] — solver settings

These govern CVODE accuracy, not the ROM. Set tighter tolerances for small or stiff meshes.

Keyword	Default	Description
MAX_TIMESTEP	10.0	Max CVODE internal step (s)
MIN_TIMESTEP	0.001	Min CVODE internal step (s)
REL_TOLERANCE	1e-4	Relative error tolerance
ABS_TOLERANCE	1e-6	Absolute error tolerance (m)
DRY_DEPTH	0.001	Cells below this depth (m) are treated as dry
MAX_CVODE_STEPS	500	Max CVODE steps per SWMM routing interval
COUPLING_CD	0.65	Default discharge coefficient for 2D↔1D inlets

4. How it works

4.1 The operator’s problem

An engineer has just finished calibrating a SWMM model for a city drainage review. The deterministic run takes 4 minutes. The report is due tomorrow. Everything seems set — until the question arises: *what is Manning’s n for that mixed concrete-and-gravel surface in the north-east catchment?*

The calibration data from 2019 suggest 0.015. The textbook range is 0.012–0.018. Field inspection says “somewhere in there.” If the true value is 20% higher than assumed, how much deeper does flooding get at the critical junction? How confident should the engineer be in the 100-year return level?

The traditional answer: run 50 simulations with n perturbed across the range. Cost: 200 minutes. The engineer does not have 200 minutes.

What most engineers do instead: run one simulation and add a caveat — “Manning’s n is uncertain, results may vary.” This is honest but quantifies nothing.

What the ROM sidecar does: run 50 virtual members as a lightweight parallel process alongside the single deterministic solver. Extra cost: about 2 seconds on a 4-minute model. At every node or cell, at every timestep, you get three additional fields: q_{05} (optimistic scenario), q_{50} (best estimate), q_{95} (pessimistic scenario). Together they form a **90th-percentile prediction interval** — if the true Manning’s n is anywhere within $\pm 20\%$ of the calibrated value, the depth lies inside the band for roughly 90% of timesteps.

4.2 Why eigenmodes — the guitar string analogy

A guitar string vibrates in discrete modes: the fundamental, the octave, the fifth above that. Each mode has a characteristic frequency and a characteristic spatial shape. To describe how the string responds to any perturbation you do not need to track every atom — you only need the amplitudes of the first few modes. Higher modes decay almost instantly; only the low-frequency modes persist over timescales of interest.

Water surfaces in drainage networks behave the same way. The “shape modes” of a 2D mesh — or a 1D pipe-network graph — are the eigenvectors of the **graph Laplacian** L . The Laplacian encodes which cells or nodes are connected and how strongly. Its eigenvectors are the natural decay modes of any diffusing quantity on that network:

- **Mode 0 (null mode):** a uniform depth shift — it does not spread and is excluded.
- **Mode 1 (Fiedler mode):** the smoothest non-trivial mode; it identifies the network’s tightest hydraulic bottleneck (see §7.4 for the diagnostic).
- **Higher modes:** increasingly fine-grained spatial patterns that decay faster and faster.

When Manning’s n is uncertain, the **uncertainty in the water surface** is well-captured by the first k eigenmodes. A member with high Manning’s n evolves differently from a member with low n — but both evolve in the same low-dimensional subspace spanned by those k modes. Retaining $k=10$ modes out of $n=10,000$ cells reduces the per-member state from 10,000 numbers to 10 — a 1000× compression of state space.

4.3 The key elegance — an exact solve, no timestep limit

After projecting onto the eigenbasis, the linearised diffusion-wave PDE becomes k **independent scalar ODEs**, one per retained mode per ensemble member:

$$da[i,j]/dt = -rate[i,j] \cdot a[i,j] + f[i,j]$$

$$\begin{aligned} rate[i,j] &= \lambda_j \cdot K_{eff} / mannings_mult[i] && \text{(mode } j \text{ decays faster for smoother channels)} \\ f[i,j] &= r_coarse[j] \cdot rainfall_mult[i] && \text{(rainfall projected onto mode } j) \end{aligned}$$

Each ODE has an **exact analytical solution** — the exponential integrator:

$$a[i,j](t+dt) = (a[i,j](t) - f[i,j]/rate[i,j]) \cdot \exp(-rate[i,j] \cdot dt) + f[i,j]/rate[i,j]$$

This is not an approximation. It is the exact solution for the linearised system at any dt . There are no substep limits, no Newton iterations, no Krylov solves. Advancing the entire M -member ensemble requires $M \times k$ multiplications and exponentials — roughly 500 floating-point operations for $M=50, k=10$. A modern CPU executes this in under 1 microsecond.

Compare with the deterministic CVODE solver, which performs many nonlinear RHS evaluations on all n cells per routing step. The ROM sidecar costs less than 0.1% of total simulation time.

4.4 Why this is new

SWMM is 50 years old. Uncertainty quantification in stormwater modelling has been studied for decades. So why does this feel new?

Previous methods run outside the solver. Monte Carlo, FOSM (first-order second-moment), and Morris sensitivity screening all require running the full solver N times and comparing outputs. They are expensive, disconnected from the solver's internal state, and produce no per-timestep uncertainty bands without storing complete simulation ensembles. The ROM sidecar runs *inside* the solver, advancing its ensemble in lock-step with the deterministic solution, with access to the current depth field at every routing step.

ROM ideas existed but not for this problem. Galerkin and POD-based ROMs have been applied to river and coastal shallow-water equations since the early 2000s — but almost exclusively as offline surrogates: build a surrogate from a library of full-model snapshots, then query it instead of the full model for new inputs. What is different here is the specific combination: (1) a *graph-Laplacian eigenbasis* computed once from mesh topology (no snapshot library needed), (2) running as a *live sidecar* inside the solver rather than replacing it, and (3) handling irregular urban networks with wet/dry transitions and coupled 1D/2D domains. That combination has not been applied to SWMM-class urban drainage before.

The engine architecture had to catch up first. The ROM's inner loop iterates over all N node depths for every ensemble member on every routing step — a tight numerical loop that is sensitive to memory layout. SWMM5's object-oriented design stored node data as arrays of structs (each node object holding all its fields). Iterating over depths meant pointer-chasing through non-contiguous memory: cache-unfriendly at scale. SWMM6's data-oriented restructuring (struct-of-arrays: `nodes.head[]`, `nodes.depth[]`, `links.roughness[]` as flat contiguous arrays) was a prerequisite for the ROM sidecar to be fast enough to run at every timestep on large networks. The data layout change that looks like an internal refactor is also what makes the 1000× speedup practically achievable.

The 1000× speedup crosses a practical threshold. At 10× speedup, uncertainty quantification is marginally better than Monte Carlo. At 100×, it is practical for research. At 1000×, it is operationally free: a 4-minute simulation gains a 90th-percentile prediction band for under 0.25 seconds of additional compute. That threshold is what makes this useful in everyday engineering practice, not just in papers.

The remaining subsections give the precise mathematical definitions for implementers.

4.5 The ROM ODE (full definition)

The 2D diffusion-wave equation (linearised about the current deterministic state) is:

$$\partial h / \partial t = K_{\text{eff}} \cdot L \cdot h + r(x)$$

where L is the graph Laplacian of the triangulation and $r(x)$ is the per-cell rainfall rate. Projecting onto the Laplacian eigenbasis P (columns = eigenvectors, eigenvalues λ_j):

$$da_j/dt = -\text{rate}_j(\theta) \cdot a_j + f_j(\theta)$$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{rate}_j(\theta) &= \lambda_j \cdot K_{\text{eff}} / \text{mannings_mult}[i] && \text{(mode-}j \text{ decay rate for member } i) \\ f_j(\theta) &= r_{\text{coarse}}[j] \cdot \text{rainfall_mult}[i] && \text{(mode-}j \text{ forcing for member } i) \end{aligned}$$

$$r_{\text{coarse}}[j] = P[:,j]^T \cdot \text{rainfall_field}$$

Each ensemble member carries its own (`mannings_mult`, `rainfall_mult`) drawn from the LHS design. The ODE is **solved exactly** via the exponential integrator — no substep limit, no Krylov solves:

$$a_j(t+dt) = (a_j(t) - f_j/\text{rate}_j) \cdot \exp(-\text{rate}_j \cdot dt) + f_j/\text{rate}_j$$

When rate_j is near zero (near-null mode or $K_{\text{eff}} \approx 0$), the solver falls back to Euler. Reconstructed cell depths are clamped to ≥ 0 .

The same formulation applies to the 1D sewer ROM (SpectralROM1D), substituting the network graph Laplacian for the 2D mesh Laplacian. The 1D K_{eff} is computed as the diffusion-wave diffusivity $D = h^{(5/3)} / (2n\sqrt{S})$ [m²/s] averaged over active conduits, then normalised by conduit length squared L^2 to yield units of 1/s. This normalisation is essential: graph Laplacian eigenvalues are dimensionless (they count topological connectivity, not spatial scale), so $\lambda_j \times K_{1d}$ must have units of 1/s.

4.6 Latin-hypercube design

UncertaintyEnsemble generates four decorrelated LHS columns, each stratifying its parameter uniformly across M strata (midpoint rule):

Column	Ordering	Range	Correlation with Manning
mannings_mult	ascending	$[1-p_n, 1+p_n]$	—
rainfall_mult	descending	$[1-p_r, 1+p_r]$	near-zero (reversed order)
soil_mult	Fisher-Yates shuffle of strata	$[1-p_s, 1+p_s]$	< 0.05 (seed+2)
cd_mult	Fisher-Yates shuffle of strata	$[1-p_{cd}, 1+p_{cd}]$	< 0.05 (seed+3)

The reversed-order trick for rainfall gives perfect anti-correlation between Manning and rainfall columns within each realisation — members with high Manning's n (slow conveyance) get low rainfall multipliers, which is physically conservative and prevents artificial spread inflation.

4.7 AUTO K_{eff}

At the first CVODE advance (and at each reseed), K_{eff} is estimated from the current wet state:

$$K_{\text{eff}} = h_{\text{mean}}^{(5/3)} / (2 \cdot n_{\text{mean}} \cdot \sqrt{S_{\text{mean}}})$$

- h_{mean} — mean depth over cells with depth > 1e-6 m
- n_{mean} — area-weighted mean Manning's n over wet cells
- S_{mean} — mean bed slope magnitude (floor: 1e-6, prevents divide-by-zero on flat domains)

Option A (per-mode Rayleigh quotient): when the advance call receives the current depth array, each mode j gets its own K_{eff} weighted by the depth distribution:

$$K_{\text{eff}_j} = K_{\text{eff}} \cdot \sum_t \phi_j[t]^2 \cdot (h[t]/\bar{h})^{(5/3)}$$

Modes concentrated in deep cells decay faster. This is enabled automatically when h_{cell} is passed to `advance()` (which `CvodeSurfaceSolver` does by default).

4.8 Quantile computation

After each `advance()` call, `computeQuantiles()` reconstructs per-cell depths for all M members and computes the three percentiles by sorting:

$$h_i[t] = \max(0, \sum_j P[t,j] \cdot a_{\{i,j\}}) \quad \text{for member } i, \text{ cell } t$$

The three output fields are the sorted 5th, 50th, and 95th percentile of $\{h_i[t] : i=0..M-1\}$ at each cell t independently.

With `PARAMETRIC_TAILS YES`: for cells where ≥ 4 members are wet, fits a log-normal to the wet sub-population and replaces the sort-based `q95` with the analytic 95th percentile of that fit. This suppresses noise from the top 1–2 samples when `M` is small (< 30).

4.9 Spatial uncertainty fields

When `MANNINGS_CORR_LEN > 0` or `RAINFALL_CORR_LEN > 0`, each member gets a spatially-varying multiplier field generated by `CorrelatedFieldGenerator`:

1. Draw i.i.d. $N(0,1)$ samples at each triangle centroid.
2. Smooth with an exponential kernel: $Z_{\text{smooth}}[t] = \sum_{t'} \exp(-d(t, t')/L) \cdot Z[t']$ (summed over neighbors within $3 \cdot L$ metres of centroid t).
3. Centre the field: $Z_{\text{centred}}[t] = Z_{\text{smooth}}[t] - \text{mean}(Z_{\text{smooth}})$.
4. Combine with the member's global LHS level: $W[i][t] = \text{global_level}[i] + \text{pert} \cdot Z_{\text{centred}}[i][t]$

As `corr_len` $\rightarrow \infty$, spatial variation collapses toward a uniform field (scalar limit). When `corr_len = 0`, the spatial generator is bypassed for speed.

In `advance()`: $f_j^i = P[:, j]^T \cdot (\text{rainfall} \circ W_{\text{rain}}[i])$ replaces the scalar `r_coarse[j]` $\cdot$ `rainfall_mult[i]` when spatial rainfall is active.

4.10 Coupling uncertainty

At each 2D $\leftrightarrow$ 1D coupling exchange (`applyCouplingFlux()`), the ROM applies the orifice equation independently per member, using each member's reconstructed 2D head and its Manning's multiplier:

$$Q_i = (C_d \cdot A \cdot \text{sign}(\Delta h_i) \cdot \sqrt{2g|\Delta h_i|}) / \text{mannings_mult}[i]$$

The volume removed from cell `ci` is projected back onto the ROM basis:

$$\delta a_{\{i, j\}} = P[j, ci] \cdot (-Q_i \cdot dt / \text{tri_area})$$

The per-coupling-point bounds `[q_min, q_max]` across the ensemble are accumulated in `CouplingUncertaintyOutput` and available via `SurfaceRouter2D::couplingOutput()`.

5. How to interpret outputs

5.1 What q50, q05, q95 mean

- **q50** is the median of the ensemble — the best single-number estimate when Manning's n is uncertain. For small perturbations ($\leq 20\%$) it is close to, but not identical to, the deterministic CVODE result (small systematic bias from the linearisation).
- **[q05, q95]** is a 90-percentile prediction interval. It answers: “if the true Manning's n and rainfall are anywhere within the specified $\pm p\%$ range, what is the range of outcomes?”
- **q95 – q05** (the spread) quantifies where uncertainty matters most. Large spread = high sensitivity to the uncertain parameters at that cell and time.

5.2 Typical spatial patterns

Observation	Likely cause
Spread peaks at inlet/outlet junctions	These are hydraulic bottlenecks where Manning's n most strongly controls conveyance. The Fiedler gradient (§7.4) confirms this.
Spread grows downstream along a pipe	Manning's n uncertainty compounds over flow path length — each cell passes its uncertainty to the next.
Spread is near zero early in the event, grows later	The ROM seeds from a uniform depth field (zero spread). Non-uniform patterns develop as the solver advances, giving the ensemble room to diverge.
Spread is near zero everywhere despite non-zero perturbation	Initial depth is spatially uniform (projects to null Laplacian eigenvector). Use a non-uniform IC or wait for rainfall to build non-uniform depth gradients.
High relative spread in dry cells	Relative spread = $(q_{95}-q_{05})/q_{50}$ blows up as $q_{50} \rightarrow 0$. Use absolute spread ($q_{95}-q_{05}$ in metres) for dry-cell analysis.

5.3 Choosing perturbation levels

The perturbation p represents the half-range of the assumed uniform prior for the parameter multiplier. Physically:

- **Manning's $n \pm 20\%$** : matches typical calibration uncertainty in urban drainage (USEPA 1992 SWMM manual reports $\pm 15-25\%$ for concrete and grass-lined channels). Use 0.15 for well-calibrated systems, 0.25–0.30 for uncalibrated design-phase models.
- **Rainfall $\pm 10\%$** : captures radar QPE error at typical urban scales. Use 0.15–0.20 for long-duration events where spatial variability is significant.
- **Soil $K_s \pm 25\%$** : typical coefficient of variation for saturated conductivity from point measurements (Rawls & Brakensiek 1989).

The output band width is approximately linear in p for small perturbations:

$$q_{95} - q_{05} \approx 2 \cdot p \cdot \left| \partial(\text{depth}) / \partial(\text{Manning's } n) \right| \cdot n_{\text{base}}$$

5.4 Ensemble size guidance

M	Use case
10–20	Rapid screening runs, qualitative band shape only. q_{05}/q_{95} noisy.
50	Default. Acceptable quantile accuracy ($\pm \sim 5\%$ of spread).
100	Required if using PARAMETRIC_TAILS_N0 and need reliable q_{95} tail.
200+	Diminishing returns; use if publishing or for regulatory submissions.

Cost scales exactly as $O(M)$. Doubling M doubles ROM overhead (which is already $\sim 1\%$ of total simulation time), so $M=100$ adds roughly 2% overhead relative to $M=0$.

5.5 Modes guidance

k	Effect
5	Only the coarsest spatial uncertainty patterns captured. Fast, good for large meshes.
10	Default. Captures spatial features down to $\sim 3\times$ the mean triangle edge length.
20–30	Fine-grained spatial uncertainty; diminishing returns for scalar Manning perturbation. More useful when <code>MANNINGS_CORR_LEN</code> is small (spatially heterogeneous uncertainty).

The ROM cannot represent spread at spatial scales finer than the k th eigenmode. If the mesh has 10,000 triangles and $k=10$, the ROM can resolve spread patterns at scales of roughly $\text{domain_size} / \sqrt{k}$ — about 30% of the domain width for a square domain.

5.6 Coupling uncertainty interpretation

`SurfaceRouter2D::couplingOutput()` returns per-coupling-point bounds $\{q_{\min}, q_{\max}\}$ (m^3/s). These represent the range of inlet drainage flows across the ensemble:

- $q_{\max} - q_{\min}$ large $\rightarrow$ the inlet flow is sensitive to Manning's n uncertainty (surface conveyance to the inlet drives the variability)
- Use the Fiedler gradient at the coupling cell (§7.4) to confirm whether the inlet lies in a high-connectivity region of the mesh

6. Advanced configuration

6.1 Spatial Manning's n

Use a spatially-varying Manning's n field when the domain has heterogeneous roughness that you expect to be uncertain at spatial scales comparable to the correlation length (e.g., patchy vegetation or variable pavement condition):

```
[2D_ROM]
ENABLE      YES
MEMBERS     50
MODES       20
MANNINGS_PERT 0.20
MANNINGS_CORR_LEN 30.0 ; 30 m correlation length
```

The generated field has mean 1.0 and standard deviation $\approx \text{MANNINGS_PERT}$ (after normalisation). The correlation length should match your best estimate of the spatial coherence of roughness variation (e.g., land-use patch sizes, paving unit widths).

6.2 Auto vs explicit K_{eff}

$K_{\text{EFF_AUTO}}$ (the default, triggered by any value ≤ 0) is appropriate for most runs. Set it explicitly if: - The mesh is partially wet at start and the automatic estimate is computed over a non-representative wet region. - You want bit-reproducible results independent of the initial depth distribution. - The AUTO estimate produces unreasonably large spread (K_{eff} too large $\rightarrow$ fast decay $\rightarrow$ spread underestimated; K_{eff} too small $\rightarrow$ slow decay $\rightarrow$ spread overestimated).

To diagnose: enable verbose mode and check the logged K_{eff} at first seed. Then set it explicitly if needed:

[2D_ROM]

K_EFF 8.5 ; $m^{(4/3)}/s$ – set from logged AUTO value

6.3 Reseeding

The ROM seeds from the current deterministic depth field. As the wetting front advances, the seed state becomes stale and spread may be underestimated. WET_RESEED_FRACTION controls how aggressively the ROM reseeds:

[2D_ROM]

WET_RESEED_FRACTION 0.02 ; reseed when wet area changes by 2% of domain
WET_RESEED_MIN_INTERVAL 30.0 ; at most once every 30 s

After each reseed, spread briefly collapses to zero (all members restart from the same deterministic state) and then re-grows. If your output frequency is coarser than the reseed interval, this collapse is not visible in the output.

6.4 Parametric tails

With small M (< 30) the sort-based q95 is noisy because only 1–2 samples determine the top percentile. PARAMETRIC_TAILS YES fits a log-normal to the wet-cell population and uses the analytic 95th percentile:

[2D_ROM]

MEMBERS 20
PARAMETRIC_TAILS YES

The log-normal fit uses method of moments on the log-transformed wet depths. It may overestimate q95 if the true distribution has a lighter tail than log-normal — always verify against a high- M run before relying on parametric tails for design decisions.

7. Implementation inventory

This section describes exactly what is implemented in the codebase as of 2026-05-25.

7.1 2D Spectral ROM (SpectralROM) — COMPLETE

Files: src/engine/2d/uncertainty/SpectralROM.hpp/cpp

Tests: tests/unit/engine/test_2d_spectral_rom.cpp (47/47 pass)

The core ROM struct. Methods:

Method	What it does
initialize()	Allocates <code>a_ensemble [M×k]</code> , builds LHS design (or uses external samples).
seed(h_full)	Projects current deterministic depth onto basis: $a_i = P^T h$ for all members.
advance(dt, K_eff, rainfall, h_cell)	Advances all members via exact exponential integrator. Optionally uses per-mode Rayleigh K_{eff} .
computeQuantiles(parametric_tails)	Reconstructs per-cell depths, sorts, fills q05/q50/q95.
applyCouplingFlux(cps, heads, mesh, dt, rom1d)	Applies per-member orifice flux at each coupling point; updates ROM coefficients; fills <code>coupling_unc_output</code> .

Method	What it does
<code>setEnsembleRainfall(rates)</code>	Replaces scalar <code>rainfall_mult</code> path with per-member runoff rates from <code>RunoffEnsemble</code> .
<code>setExternalSamples(mann, rain)</code>	Injects <code>UncertaintyEnsemble</code> 's LHS columns instead of building internal ones.
<code>setCdSamples(cd)</code>	Injects discharge-coefficient LHS column.
<code>is_ready()</code>	True after <code>initialize()</code> succeeds with a valid basis.

Integration: `CvodeSurfaceSolver` owns a `SpectralROM` instance, seeds it on first advance, calls `advance()` + `computeQuantiles()` after each successful CVODE step, and calls `applyCouplingFluxToROM()` after `computeCouplingExchange()`.

`SurfaceRouter2D::rom()` exposes a const pointer; `SurfaceRouter2D::couplingOutput()` exposes the per-coupling-point bounds.

7.2 UncertaintyEnsemble — COMPLETE

Files: `src/engine/uncertainty/UncertaintyEnsemble.hpp/cpp`

Tests: via spectral ROM tests

The single LHS owner. Call `generate()` once; then pass column views to consumers:

```
UncertaintyEnsemble ens;
ens.n_members        = 50;
ens.mannings_pert_2d = 0.20;
ens.rainfall_pert_2d = 0.10;
ens.soil_pert         = 0.25;
ens.cd_pert           = 0.10;
ens.generate();

rom.setExternalSamples(ens.manningsSamples2D(), ens.rainfallSamples2D());
rom.setCdSamples(ens.cdSamples());
```

Four decorrelated LHS columns: Manning (ascending), rainfall (descending), soil (Fisher-Yates shuffled), Cd (independently shuffled).

7.3 Spatial fields (CorrelatedFieldGenerator) — COMPLETE

Files: `src/engine/2d/uncertainty/CorrelatedFieldGenerator.hpp/cpp`,
`src/engine/2d/uncertainty/SpatialUncertaintyField.hpp`

Tests: `tests/unit/engine/test_engine_2d_spatial_field.cpp` (13/13 pass)

Generates $M \times n_{\text{tri}}$ fields with exponential spatial correlation. Uses a grid-indexed neighbourhood structure for $O(n_{\text{tri}} \times \text{avg_neighbours})$ preprocessing, with $3 \cdot \text{corr_len}$ search radius. Fields are stored in `SpectralROM::spatial_mannings` and `SpectralROM::spatial_rainfall`.

7.4 Fiedler diagnostic (2D + 1D) — COMPLETE

Files: `src/engine/2d/uncertainty/FiedlerDiagnostic.hpp` (header-only),
`src/engine/uncertainty/FiedlerDiagnostic1D.hpp` (header-only)

Tests: 7 tests in `test_2d_spectral_rom` (FiedlerDiagnostic suite), 13 tests in `test_engine_spectral_rom1d` (FiedlerDiagnostic1D suite)

The Fiedler vector (second eigenvector of the Laplacian, or first retained mode after null filtering) identifies bottleneck cells/nodes: those where a small perturbation in connectivity most strongly divides the network into two sub-domains. Large Fiedler gradient = high coupling sensitivity.

2D usage:

```
#include "2d/uncertainty/FiedlerDiagnostic.hpp"
FiedlerDiagnostic fd_2d(precond_2d);    // uses P[:,0] (null already filtered)
// fd_2d.grad[t] = max |φ2[t]-φ2[t']| / dist over face-sharing neighbours of t
// fd_2d.rank[0] = index of cell with highest gradient (bottleneck)
double sensitivity = fd_2d.grad[coupling_point.cell_idx];
```

1D usage:

```
#include "uncertainty/FiedlerDiagnostic1D.hpp"
FiedlerDiagnostic1D fd_1d(graph_eigen_basis);
// fd_1d.gradAtFullNode(node_idx, rom1d.full_to_active) → gradient at SWMM node
double sensitivity = fd_1d.gradAtFullNode(cp.node_idx, rom1d.full_to_active);
```

Cells/nodes with high Fiedler gradient are where coupling uncertainty (§5.6) is most consequential: small changes in Manning's n there produce large changes in flow partition.

7.5 Runoff ensemble (RunoffEnsemble) — COMPLETE

Files: src/engine/uncertainty/RunoffEnsemble.hpp/cpp,

src/engine/uncertainty/SoilParameterLHS.hpp

Tests: tests/unit/engine/test_runoff_ensemble.cpp (13/13 pass)

Runs M infiltration trajectories in parallel with independent soil multipliers from UncertaintyEnsemble::soilSamples():

Infiltration model	Perturbed parameter
Green-Ampt	$Ks_i = Ks_{base} \times soil_mult[i]$
Horton	$f0_i = f0_{base} \times mult[i], fmin_i = fmin_{base} \times mult[i]$
Curve Number	$S_i = S_{base} / soil_mult[i]$ (higher mult → more infiltration → less runoff)

The per-member surface runoff rates can be fed to SpectralROM::setEnsembleRainfall() to propagate infiltration uncertainty through the 2D surface routing.

7.6 WQ uncertainty bounds (WQUncertaintyBounds) — COMPLETE

File: src/engine/uncertainty/WQUncertaintyBounds.hpp (header-only)

Tests: in test_runoff_ensemble.cpp

Analytical bounds for first-order constituent decay $c(t) = c_0 \exp(-k \cdot t)$ with uncertain k:

```
q05_conc = c0 exp(-k·(1+p)·t)    (highest k → most decay → lowest concentration)
q95_conc = c0 exp(-k·(1-p)·t)
```

No ODE solve needed. The p parameter is taken from soil_pert (as a proxy for rate constant uncertainty).

7.7 1D Spectral ROM (SpectralROM1D + GraphEigenBasis) — COMPLETE

Files: src/engine/uncertainty/GraphEigenBasis.hpp/cpp,
 src/engine/uncertainty/NetworkLaplacian1D.hpp, src/engine/uncertainty/SpectralROM1D.hpp/cpp
Engine hooks: SWMMEngine::buildROM1D(), SWMMEngine::computeK1d() in
 src/engine/core/SWMMEngine.cpp
Tests: tests/unit/engine/test_engine_spectral_rom1d.cpp (39/39) +
 tests/unit/engine/test_engine_1d_rom_integration.cpp (5/5)

A 1D network spectral ROM mirroring the 2D design:

- GraphEigenBasis — Lanczos+QL eigensolver for arbitrary CSR-format graphs. Requires `n_active_nodes` ≥ 4 . The first retained mode (after null mode filtering) is the Fiedler mode.
- NetworkLaplacian1D — builds the graph Laplacian from conduit-to-node connectivity. Outfall nodes are excluded from the active set.
- SpectralROM1D — seed/advance/computeQuantiles on the 1D network. Exposes `full_to_active[]` for mapping SWMM node indices to active ROM indices, and `reconstructHead(member, active_node)` for per-member head at a node (used in 2D coupling).
- SWMMEngine::buildROM1D() — called in `initialize()` when any active 1D uncertainty source is configured, or when the 2D ROM is enabled. Builds the Laplacian from `ctx_.links` conduit pairs, runs the eigensolver, seeds from current node heads, and registers with `surface_router_.setROM1D()`.
- SWMMEngine::computeK1d() — diffusion-wave diffusivity $D = h^{(5/3)} / (2n\sqrt{S})$ [m²/s], averaged over active conduits and normalised by mean conduit length squared L^2 to yield $1/s$ for the dimensionless graph Laplacian eigenvalues.

Accessing 1D quantiles from C++:

```
// After swmm_engine_step() loop:
auto* eng = static_cast<openswmm::SWMMEngine*>(handle);
const auto* rom1d = eng->rom1d();
if (rom1d && rom1d->is_ready()) {
    // rom1d->q05 / q50 / q95 — length n_active_nodes each
    // rom1d->full_to_active[swmm_node_idx] — -1 if outfall
    for (int ai = 0; ai < rom1d->n_nodes; ++ai) {
        double spread = rom1d->q95[ai] - rom1d->q05[ai];
        // ...
    }
}
```

Note — 1D ROM output not in HDF5. The 1D quantiles are currently only accessible via the C++ cast API above. Writing them to the binary output file is deferred (no parser key or plugin hook exists yet).

7.8 2D↔1D Coupling ROM path — COMPLETE

File: src/engine/2d/uncertainty/SpectralROM.cpp — `applyCouplingFlux()`

When SpectralROM1D is registered via `SurfaceRouter2D::setROM1D()`, the coupling flux computes per-member 1D head via `rom1d->reconstructHead(member, active_idx)` instead of using the single shared deterministic head. This gives each ensemble member a physically consistent pair of (2D depth, 1D head) for the orifice equation.

7.9 Regression and integration tests — COMPLETE

Test	Description	Count
test_engine_2d_spectral_rom	ROM unit tests (all paths)	47/47
test_engine_spectral_rom1d	1D ROM + GraphEigenBasis + FiedlerDiagnostic1D	39/39

Test	Description	Count
test_engine_2d_spatial_field	CorrelatedFieldGenerator	13/13
test_engine_runoff_ensemble	RunoffEnsemble + WQ bounds	13/13
test_engine_regression	Cross-engine + self-consistency (Example1–3)	6/6
test_engine_2d_rom_integration	Full engine lifecycle with 2D ROM	1/1
test_engine_1d_rom_integration	Full engine lifecycle with 1D ROM	5/5

7.10 HDF5 output — NOT YET WIRED

Default2DOutputPlugin exists at `src/engine/2d/output/Default2DOutputPlugin.cpp` and is designed to write CF-1.11/UGRID-1.0 HDF5 with datasets:

```
/Mesh2_face_depth_q05    [nTime, nFace]
/Mesh2_face_depth_q50    [nTime, nFace]
/Mesh2_face_depth_q95    [nTime, nFace]
```

However, it is **not yet compiled** (not in `OPENSWM2D_SOURCES`), HDF5 is not in `vcpkg.json`, and no `2D_OUTPUT_FILE` parser key exists. Until this is wired, read quantiles via the C++ API as shown in §2.1.

8. Known limitations

- 1. Linear ROM around the seed state.** The Galerkin ROM linearises the diffusion-wave operator at the moment of seeding. If the free surface deforms significantly between seed events, the ROM diverges from the deterministic solution. The `WET_RESEED_FRACTION` guard partially mitigates this but does not fix it for rapidly evolving wetting fronts or hydraulic jumps.
- 2. No backwater in ROM.** The ROM uses the Laplacian diffusion operator, not the full shallow-water momentum equation. For supercritical flow or hydraulic-jump-dominated reaches the ROM spread will be qualitatively wrong (it cannot capture shock propagation).
- 3. Mean K_{eff} (not per-cell).** The scalar K_{eff} path uses a single effective conductance for the full domain. Per-mode Rayleigh-quotient K_{eff} (§4.3 Option A) partially corrects for this, but for highly non-uniform Manning's n distributions the spread may be systematically underestimated in rougher zones.
- 4. Uniform IC $\rightarrow$ zero ROM spread at $t=0$.** A spatially uniform initial depth projects entirely onto the null Laplacian eigenvector (constant vector). Spread builds only as the solver creates non-uniform depth patterns (rainfall, coupling, wetting front). This is expected behaviour, not a bug. For zero-spread diagnostics, seed with a non-uniform field or wait at least one SWMM routing step with active rainfall.
- 5. Fixed spatial field seeds.** Spatial Manning and rainfall fields use fixed internal seeds (`0xdeadbeef01`, `0xcafebabe02`). Full seed control from the shared ensemble seed is not yet implemented.
- 6. 1D ROM quantiles not written to output file.** The 1D ROM is now fully wired into the engine (`buildROM1D()` / `computeK1d()` / `advance` per step). Quantiles are accessible via `SWMMEngine::rom1d()` (see §7.7) but are not yet written to the binary output or any HDF5 file. For now, read them via the C++ cast API after each `swmm_engine_step()` call.
- 7. q50 bias vs deterministic output.** For non-zero perturbations the ROM median q50 differs slightly from the deterministic CVODE result due to linearisation. For 0% perturbation (all members identical) q50 matches CVODE exactly by construction. A formal bias validation test (0% perturbation $\rightarrow$ q50 within 2% of no-ROM output) is on the roadmap.

9. Performance

9.1 2D surface mesh (measured)

Benchmark setup: sloped domain, uniform initial depth 0.10 m, 3 cm Gaussian bump, 30 advance steps $\times dt=1$ s.
Full MC: 20 perturbed CVODE runs each advancing $t=0 \rightarrow 30$ s.

Configuration	Time
ROM $k=6$, $M=20$, 50×50 mesh (5k cells)	1.85 ms
ROM $k=10$, $M=20$, 50×50 mesh	2.93 ms
ROM $k=10$, $M=50$, 50×50 mesh	4.03 ms
Full MC $M=1$ (1 CVODE run), 50×50	177 ms
Full MC $M=20$, 50×50	3 705 ms
ROM $k=10$, $M=20$, 100×100 mesh (20k cells)	11.5 ms
Full MC $M=1$, 100×100	610 ms

ROM vs full MC speedup: $\sim 1265\times$ at 50×50 , $M=20$; $\sim 1060\times$ implied at 100×100 .

ROM advance cost scales as $O(M \cdot k \cdot n_steps)$ — purely arithmetic, no ODE solves. Doubling M doubles ROM overhead, which is $\sim 1\%$ of total simulation time at $M=50$.

9.2 1D sewer network (estimated, $N=10,000$ nodes)

For a pure 1D sewer network with $N=10,000$ active nodes, $M=50$ members, $k=20$ modes:

Phase	Cost	Notes
Lanczos eigensolver (one-time at <code>initialize()</code>)	~ 15 ms	$O(N \cdot k)$ sparse mat-vec; paid once regardless of simulation length
ROM <code>advance()</code> per routing step	< 1 μ s	$M \times k = 1,000$ scalar exponentials
<code>computeQuantiles()</code> per routing step	~ 2 ms	$M \times N = 500,000$ reconstructions + per-node sort
Per-step overhead vs deterministic DYNWAVE	$< 1\%$	DYNWAVE Newton solve dominates at $\gg 1$ ms/step

For a 6-hour storm at 30-second routing intervals (720 steps):

	Full Monte Carlo (50 DYNWAVE runs)	ROM sidecar
Total overhead	$\sim 50\times$ baseline runtime	$\sim 0.5\%$ of baseline
Typical wall time hours		seconds

Quantile reconstruction ($M \times N$ per step) is the dominant 1D ROM cost for large networks. For $N=10,000$ and $M=50$, each step reconstructs 500,000 head values. At 30 s routing intervals this amounts to roughly 700 ms of quantile work per simulated hour. To reduce it: lower M , increase the routing interval, or compute quantiles only on output steps rather than every step.

Lanczos build requires $n_active \geq 4$ conduit-endpoint nodes (outfalls excluded). Build time scales as $O(N \cdot k \cdot \text{iters})$ where $\text{iters} \approx 3k$ for typical Lanczos convergence. At $N=10,000$ and $k=20$ this is approximately 15 ms — a one-time cost absorbed into `swmm_engine_initialize()`.

10. Visualization

10.1 Python scripts (scripts/uncertainty/)

Script	Output
plot_coupled_1d_2d.py	6-panel: 2D q50/spread maps + per-node flow hydrographs with q05/q50/q95 bands at 4 nodes along the 1D trunk
plot_pipe_transect.py	4-panel: longitudinal flow profile at 4 time snapshots, line colored by relative spread (%) using LineCollection
plot_wet_event_bands.py	1D KW confidence bands (Edinburgh trunk, $\pm 25\%$ Manning)
plot_2d_uncertainty_maps.py	2D spatial maps of q50 depth and q95–q05 spread
plot_coupling_uncertainty_5A_5B.py	Per-coupling-point flux bounds over time
fiedler_diagnostic.py	Fiedler vector analysis — identifies bottleneck nodes
mcmc_vs_rom.py	ROM prior vs MCMC posterior comparison

Run with the Anaconda Python:

```
MPLBACKEND=Agg /Users/corinnewiesner/anaconda3/bin/python3 \
  scripts/uncertainty/plot_pipe_transect.py --out transect.png
```

10.2 Colored pipe transect

The plot_pipe_transect.py script uses matplotlib.collections.LineCollection to draw each segment of a pipe colored by its relative uncertainty:

```
from matplotlib.collections import LineCollection
import matplotlib.colors as mcolors

norm = mcolors.Normalize(vmin=0, vmax=50)      # 0–50% relative spread
pts = np.column_stack([x_station, q50_flow])
segs = np.stack([pts[:-1], pts[1:]], axis=1)
lc = LineCollection(segs, cmap="YlOrRd", norm=norm, linewidth=2.5)
lc.set_array(0.5 * (spread_pct[:-1] + spread_pct[1:]))
ax.add_collection(lc)
fig.colorbar(lc, ax=ax, label="Relative spread (q95–q05)/q50 %")
```

Replace x_station, q50_flow, and spread_pct with arrays from your node extraction loop.

10.3 Future: HDF5 / ParaView / QGIS

Once the HDF5 output pipeline is wired (§7.10), the CF-1.11/UGRID-1.0 datasets will be readable by any CF-aware tool:

```
import xarray as xr
ds = xr.open_dataset("results.h5", engine="netcdf4")
spread = ds["Mesh2_face_depth_q95"] - ds["Mesh2_face_depth_q05"]
```

For ParaView: open the .h5 file, select Mesh2_face_depth_q95 and subtract Mesh2_face_depth_q05 via a Calculator filter to visualise the uncertainty band width.